

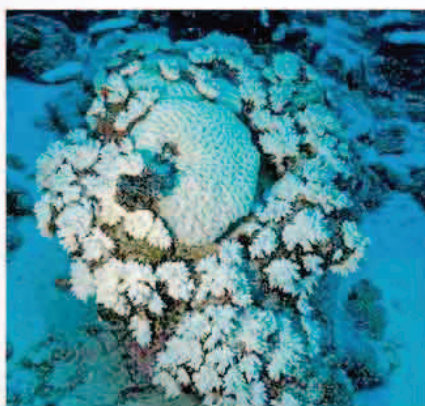


▲ NORTHERN HURRICANE

In 2012, Hurricane Sandy swept so far north from the Caribbean that storms battered the coast of Maine.

WOW!

Some scientists predict that, by the year 2050, all the summer ice at the North Pole will melt away because of global warming.



CORAL BLEACHING

Unusually warm seas make reef corals expel the tiny algae that supply them with food, making them turn white. If the water cools down again, the corals can recover, but if not, they die. This has happened several times in recent years, and may become an annual event. Scientists warn that this coral bleaching could destroy most of the world's coral reefs within 100 years.

ACID BATH

Global climate change is being caused by more carbon dioxide in the atmosphere. A lot of this gas is absorbed by ocean water, but it mixes with water to form carbonic acid. The acid makes the oceans less alkaline, with fewer of the dissolved chalky minerals that shellfish and corals need to make their shells and skeletons. This could be fatal to many types of sea life, and to all the animals that rely on them for food.

► THREAT TO SHELLS

These washed-up shells are made of alkaline minerals that could become scarce in the oceans of the future.

